Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Diagnostic Testing for Influenza

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Testing for influenza (CPT code 87804, CPT code 87400, CPT code 87501, CPT code 87502, CPT code 87275, CPT code 87276) **IS REIMBURSABLE** for diagnosis of patients who present with one or more of the following:

  - Abdominal pain
  - Acute bronchitis
  - Acute sinusitis
  - Acute tonsillitis, laryngitis or tracheitis
  - Chest pain
  - Cough
  - Dehydration
  - Fatigue
  - Fever
  - Gastritis, unspecified, without bleeding
  - Headache
  - Infectious mononucleosis
  - Muscle weakness
  - Nausea or vomiting
  - Pharyngitis
  - Shortness of breath
  - Upper respiratory infection
  - Viral infections
  - Viral intestinal infection, unspecified
  - Viral or bacterial pneumonia
  - Whooping cough

- Testing with infectious agent antigen detection by immunoassay with direct optical observation (CPT code 87804) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** with another influenza test (CPT code 87400, CPT code 87501, CPT code 87502, CPT code 87275, CPT code 87276).

- For all other situations not described above, testing for influenza (CPT code 87804, CPT code 87400, CPT code 87501, CPT code 87502, CPT code 87275, CPT code 87276) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

- Viral culture testing for influenza (CPT code 87254) with a diagnosis of influenza **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

- Serology testing for influenza (CPT code 86710) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE**.

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure code	Code description
86710	Antibody; influenza virus
87254	Virus isolation; centrifuge enhanced (shell vial) technique, includes identification with immunofluorescence stain, each virus
87275	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunofluorescent technique; influenza B virus
87276	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunofluorescent technique; influenza A virus
87400	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunoassay technique, (eg, enzyme immunoassay [EIA], enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay [ELISA], fluorescence immunoassay [FIA], immunochemiluminometric assay [IMCA]) qualitative or semiquantitative, Influenza, A or B, each
87501	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); influenza virus, includes reverse transcription, when performed, and amplified probe technique, each type or subtype
87502	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); influenza virus, for multiple types or sub-types, includes multiplex reverse transcription, when performed, and multiplex amplified probe technique, first 2 types or sub-types
87804	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunoassay with direct optical (i.e. visual) observation; influenza

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